

STAGE SEVEN • HARD SKILLS

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each section, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Seven • Hard Skills

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below before the first sub-session of each section (e.g., before 1A, before 2A). Given this stage's emphasis on continuity — one real dataset, project, or portfolio carried across multiple sub-sessions — this pre-work matters more here than in most other stages.

Before Data & Analysis (1A/1B)

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SECTION

- Bring or identify one real, messy dataset (school, work, or public) to use across both sub-sessions.
- Have Excel or Google Sheets access confirmed before arriving.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Working with a real dataset throughout, rather than a fresh example each time, produces a more coherent, genuinely useful body of practice.

Before Documents & Written Communication (2A/2B)

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SECTION

- Identify a real topic or project you can write about across both sub-sessions.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Writing about the same real subject across multiple exercises lets each one build on the last, rather than starting from scratch each time.

Before Planning & Project Management (3A/3B/3C)

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SECTION

- Identify one real, moderately complex project to plan and, eventually, execute across all three sub-sessions.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This section's entire arc, planning through execution through closure, only works as a coherent experience if it's the same real project throughout.

Before Visual & Presentation Tools (4A/4B)

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SECTION

- Bring a phone or recording device.
- Bring or begin an online portfolio if one doesn't already exist.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several exercises in this section require live recording or an existing portfolio to build on —

arriving without either costs real session time.

Before Digital Tools & Systems (5A/5B)

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SECTION

- Bring a laptop with access to at least one collaboration tool and one automation-capable tool (e.g., Zapier, or built-in automation in Sheets/Excel).

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the most technically hands-on section in the stage; the right device and access prevents session time from being lost to setup.

Before Collaboration & Reflection (6A/6B)

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SECTION

- Gather all worksheets and reflections completed across Sections 1–5.
- Set aside real time — 6B in particular is a genuine, comprehensive stage close, not a quick wrap-up.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several FIRSTS in this closing section explicitly ask you to look back across everything completed earlier in the stage.